

DMS.app

A document and photo management system that stores real files on your own drive — organized as a folder tree, searchable by content, and equally at home managing a family archive or an industrial equipment databook.

Document	Storage Model	Platforms	Sheets
Feature Index — rev. 2026-09-12	Local files, own hardware	macOS · Windows · LAN	01-12 + Audience Index

01

Organize

A folder tree that mirrors how the work is actually structured — an assembly, a property, a family filing cabinet.

Hierarchical folder tree — build nested folders that match a real assembly, org, or filing structure.

Drag to reorder or move — the underlying files on disk move with the folder, automatically.

Serial number field per folder — keep consistent asset or item numbering built into the tree itself.

Recycle bin, not permanent delete — deleted items land in a "Not Show in Tree" bin and can be restored.

Bulk remove from a folder — select several documents and clear them from a folder in one action; anything left with no other link moves to the recycle bin, nothing is deleted from disk.

Bulk hierarchy import — build hundreds of folders in one pass from a simple CSV-style definition file, including bill-of-materials structures where the same part name legitimately repeats under different parents.

Preview before you commit — check an imported hierarchy for errors before it's created.

Real folders on disk — the tree is mirrored as an actual folder structure, not just a database record.

Photo-root auto-sorting — designate a folder that automatically files incoming photos by year and month.

02

Capture & Import

Getting documents in should be as easy as the moment you have them in hand.

Drag-and-drop upload — drop files straight from the desktop or Finder/Explorer.

Paste from clipboard — Cmd/Ctrl+V a screenshot directly into a folder, no save-then-upload step.

Mobile capture via QR code — scan a code, take a phone photo, and it lands straight in the right folder.

Batch ZIP import — drop in a whole ZIP archive and DMS sorts the contents into folders automatically.

Mirror an existing folder structure — uploading one or more folders can now recreate their exact subfolder layout inside DMS instead of auto-sorting everything by date.

Duplicate detection — flags files already in the library on upload — skip, link to the existing copy, or upload anyway.

HEIC support — iPhone photos preview correctly without a manual conversion step.

EXIF-aware photo filing — reads GPS and capture date from photos, with reverse geocoding, to auto-file them by year, month, and place.

Automatic document-date detection — the date on a document's own first page is read at upload time and proposed right away — ready to confirm, and ready to feed the trend charts (Sheet 06) with nothing extra to type.

Voice input for descriptions — dictate a photo or document's description — speech is transcribed and appended automatically, accented speech included.

Upload limit raised to 4GB — the old 1GB cap could stall or fail on bulk imports of tens of thousands of files; raised to 4GB for steadier large-batch import and export.

- **Videos auto-filed by year/month too** NEW — MP4/MOV-family files read their embedded recording timestamp directly; other video formats fall back to the file's modified date — the same year/month filing rule photos already use.

03 View & Merge

Read and consolidate documents without leaving the browser.

In-browser preview — PDFs, images, and Office files open directly, no download required.

Full in-app PDF viewer — page navigation and zoom, plus a fuzzy "find in document" search that tolerates OCR typos and jumps straight to the highlighted match on the page.

Download several documents to a folder — select any set of documents and copy them out to a folder of your choice (the OS Downloads folder by default), with an option to reveal them when done.

Rename a document from its card — renames the file on disk and keeps the display name in sync, no separate step.

Combine documents into one PDF — merge selected scans or photos into a single PDF filed back into a folder; photos are compressed first (900px longest edge, JPEG 85%) with no visible loss but up to ~100x smaller — a 136-photo contract can go from 2.3GB to about 18MB. The merged-away originals move to the recycle folder (use the Sheet 08 Databook instead if you need to keep them); quick merges skip the formal cover page, use per-document bookmarks for navigation, and normalize every page to portrait.

Open in native app — one click hands a document off to the default OS viewer or editor.

Drag to link an existing document — in "Link existing document," drag a search or browse result straight onto a target folder to attach it — no per-item confirm click needed.

Persistent current-document highlight — opening a document (in the viewer or a native app) keeps it highlighted in its folder's list, so it's easy to find again.

- **List / icon view, with small or large thumbnails** NEW — toggle between a detailed list and a thumbnail grid; icon view adds a further Small/Large thumbnail-size toggle, and the choice is remembered.
- **Previous / next document** NEW — click the arrows in the preview window, or just the left/right arrow keys, to step through a folder's documents without closing and reopening the viewer.
- **Sort by due date, modified date, and more** NEW — order the document list by name, document date, due date, or date modified — no longer just filename order.
- **Batch rename** NEW — one click renames every document in a folder to "date + first 10 characters of location + original name," pulling date and location from each document's own metadata and renaming the actual file on disk too.
- **Due dates & "Schedule" color warnings** NEW — set a due date on any document, then turn on "Schedule" mode to color-code documents and folders by urgency (red within 1 day, yellow within 1 week, blue within 2 weeks) and pop open an urgency-ranked "Documents due soon" list.

Find anything, and pull structured data straight out of a scanned page.

Live search — filters instantly across filenames, OCR'd text, and metadata.

Automatic OCR — scanned PDFs and images get OCR'd on the spot, multi-language, with a force-OCR override for stubborn scans.

Garbled-text detection — catches bad OCR output before it pollutes search results.

Custom key-parameter extraction — define labels like "Max Working Pressure" or "Serial No." and pull their values straight out of a document's text.

Structured results — each match is split into value, unit, and description — not one raw text blob.

Repeated-key handling — a label that appears more than once in a document is captured as separate, numbered results.

CSV metadata export — every document and its metadata, one row each, ready to open in Excel.

Design-value / actual-value pair — each key parameter can hold both a "design" and an "actual" reading, each with its own value, unit, and description — ready for compliance checks and deviation analysis.

Interactive preview flyout — while entering or double-checking a parameter by hand, pop open a draggable, resizable preview of the source document — no more tabbing back and forth.

05

AI Assist

Opt-in, bring-your-own API key — for the documents plain search and regex can't handle.

AI-powered key extraction — reads a document's actual page images to pull key values out of layouts that defeat text-pattern matching.

Ask AI across the whole project — ask a plain-language question over every document (or one folder) and get an answer with citations back to the source files.

Guided key setup — in-app instructions for getting and saving a Gemini API key, encrypted at rest.

DeepSeek model added — choose DeepSeek alongside Gemini as the Q&A engine — faster and steadier for users on mainland China networks.

Q&A history saved automatically — every question and answer is appended to a running PDF log kept alongside the document — searchable, and always there later.

- **Package as a PDF for any AI platform** NEW — pick a batch of photos, write (or dictate and AI-polish) a request and a story, and bundle it all into one small, compressed PDF — hand it to ChatGPT, Gemini, or any vision-capable AI platform to generate a short video, an article, or anything else DMS itself doesn't produce.

06

Trend Charts

Turn a repeated key parameter into a chart, without leaving the folder it lives in.

Parameter vs. time chart — pick a folder and a numeric key parameter (from key extraction or manual metadata) and see every value plotted against date, optionally including subfolders.

Automatic timeline — dates come from each document's own detected or entered date, or — failing that — from the "YYYY-MM" folder it's filed under.

Click a point, open the document — jump straight from a plotted value, or a row in the table beneath it, to the source document.

Gemini trend commentary — opt-in AI read on the trend's direction, approximate rate of change, and any outliers worth a second look.

Free-floating, resizable — and pop-out — chart window — no longer fixed and centered: drag the header to move it, drag an edge to resize, or pop it out into its own browser window to drag onto a second monitor.

Manual axis ranges — toggle either axis between Auto and Custom; switching to Custom starts from the current auto-fit range and updates live as you edit it.

Two annualized-return modes — pick a point as the baseline to see every other point's annualized return against it, or a chained point-to-point annualized return — built for tracking account balances and investment returns.

Excel snapshot history — one click on "Save snapshot" appends today's date and value to a per-folder, per-parameter Excel history file; "Total vs. time" reads it straight back into a chart — ideal for a running balance that isn't extracted from any single document.

07

Photos & Face Recognition

For libraries where the photos are as important as the paperwork.

Tag a face once — DMS builds a People directory automatically from that point on.

Click a person, see every photo — the People view collects every appearance across the library.

Auto-scan for matches — find more photos of a tagged person (or everyone) in a folder or the whole library, with an adjustable match-confidence threshold.

One-click engine setup — guided installer for the underlying face-recognition engine, with live progress.

Clean removal — delete a person and every one of their tags in a single action.

One-click shooting location — for GPS-tagged photos, jump straight to the shooting location on Google Maps.

- **Find near-duplicate photos, clean up in one pass** NEW — select a batch of photos and set a similarity threshold (75% by default); DMS groups burst shots and repeat exports together and marks the highest-resolution, best-quality copy in each group with a ★ recommendation. Confirm, and the group gets linked into a review folder for side-by-side comparison and cleanup — the originals' own folder is untouched.

08

Databook Output

Turn a folder tree into a bound handoff package, in one click.

Generate a bound PDF databook — from any set of documents across the tree, with an auto-built cover page, table of contents, and per-section bookmarks.

Structure follows your tree — folder order, serial numbers, and paths become the databook's section structure.

Custom front page — insert your own cover ahead of the auto-generated one.

Photo sections handled automatically — image-only folders convert into print-ready PDF pages.

Automatic portrait normalization — a landscape source page is rotated to display upright, so a merged databook holds one consistent orientation throughout.

Compact photo-heavy output — images are intelligently re-compressed before embedding, cutting the file size of a photo-heavy databook by two orders of magnitude with no visible loss on the page.

09

Share & Remote Access

Get a document — or a whole upload point — to someone who isn't in front of the same computer.

Send to Phone — generates a one-hour download link and texts it via iMessage/SMS (Mac) or Phone Link (Windows) — no app needed on the receiving end.

Send by email — attach and send a document directly from the app.

Remote Upload link — a public link with a QR code that lets a colleague or contractor upload straight into the project from anywhere, no account required.

Built-in secure tunnel — remote links work with no router or port configuration on your end.

Same-network access — other devices on the same Wi-Fi connect directly — no internet dependency at all.

Browse the full tree from a phone browser — open the same remote link on a phone and browse the whole folder tree as if at the computer — not just receive one file at a time.

10

Backup & Portability

Nothing here is locked in. The files are yours, in formats anything can open.

Real files, standard formats — PDFs and images sit in normal folders on disk, never a proprietary blob.

Cloud sync for free — point the storage folder at OneDrive, Dropbox, or iCloud and syncing just happens.

Automatic rolling backups — the most recent backups are kept, older ones auto-archived rather than silently deleted.

Flexible manual export — metadata only, a complete backup with every file, or just selected folders.

Encrypted exports for protected projects — a project with its own password (see Security, Sheet 11) has every .dms export automatically encrypted with it — no separate export password to set.

Import and inspect — restore a backup file, or check what's inside one before committing to the import.

Guided OneDrive setup — step-by-step instructions built into the app.

11 Security & Access

Lock down the whole library, or just the sensitive parts of it.

Library-wide password — optional login screen protecting the entire application, on this machine, regardless of which project is open — salted and hashed.

Per-project password — a second, independent password that belongs to one specific project — stored inside its own folder, so it travels along on a copy, a sync, or a handoff. Required to open that project directly, or to import its exported .dms file anywhere else.

Named projects — give a password-protected project a friendly name, shown on its lock screen and in the file picker.

Per-folder credential storage — save a login (URL, account, password) against a specific folder — e.g. an equipment portal — decrypted only when you click reveal.

Self-expiring share links — every "Send to Phone" link stops working after one hour.

Secrets encrypted at rest — API keys, folder passwords, project passwords, and email credentials are never stored in plain text.

Multiple logins per folder — a folder used to hold one website/username/password; now it can hold any number, with a one-click "copy username" that doesn't round-trip to the server.

12 Runs Anywhere, Speaks Two Languages

Low-friction install, low-friction daily use.

One-click desktop launcher — for Mac and Windows, installs its own missing dependencies automatically.

Fully bilingual UI — Chinese and English throughout, switchable instantly.

Translated guides, in-app — setup instructions and a full user manual, downloadable in either language.

Self-healing launch — detects a stale or crashed prior session and clears the port automatically, rather than failing to start.

- **Multiple projects at once** NEW — run several DMS project windows/instances side by side and switch between them freely, no need to close one before opening another.

- **No document count limit** NEW — a project can hold an unlimited number of documents.

Audience Index

Who It's For

The same underlying system, pointed at very different filing cabinets. A few of the sheets above that matter most to each.

Industrial / Engineering

Assembly & equipment databooks

- Serial-numbered assembly hierarchy, built in bulk from a BOM
- Design-vs-actual key parameters, pulled straight out of scanned drawings
- Parameter trend charts across a serial-numbered fleet, with an AI read on drift
- One-click bound databook: cover, TOC, bookmarks — compact even with hundreds of photos
- Per-asset credential storage for equipment portals

Facilities / Field Ops

Equipment & site records

- QR mobile capture — photo an asset, it files itself
- GPS + date auto-organizing for site photos
- Mirror an existing site archive's folder structure on import
- Remote Upload link for contractors, no account needed
- Same-network access on the shop floor, no internet required

Small Business / Admin

Records, contracts, invoices

- CSV metadata export for bookkeeping
- Library-wide password, plus a separate password on a sensitive client project
- Send to Phone / email for quick client handoffs
- Free backup via existing OneDrive or Dropbox, encrypted if the project is protected

Family / Personal

Medical, insurance, estate & everyday documents

- Medical records & HSA/FSA receipts — OCR'd and searchable, so a \$340 dermatology bill from March is easy to find again at reimbursement time; export a year's receipts to CSV for taxes
- Insurance policies — home, auto, health, life — one per folder, with policy number, coverage, and expiration pulled out automatically
- Wills & living wills — a project password of their own, backed up as real files (encrypted) your family can open without an account when it matters most
- College applications & everyday paperwork — one folder per child, drag-and-drop scans, phone-camera upload with no app to install
- Face recognition — browse the family photo library by person, in a bilingual interface for multi-language households

Shoots, albums, guest photos

- People view — tag once, find every photo of someone
- Batch ZIP import of a full shoot in one drop
- Mirror an existing shoot's folder structure instead of re-sorting it by date
- Auto-organizing by capture date and location
- Near-duplicate burst shots auto-grouped, with the keeper recommended
- Combine selected shots into a single deliverable PDF